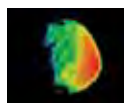




### Herbivores ate shellfish

Even herbivorous dinosaurs couldn't resist the taste of shellfish, their poop reveals. <http://dgit.in/NonvegDino>



### NASA's Odyssey captures Phobos

NASA's Odyssey orbiter which has been going around Mars recently sent photos of the Martian moon Phobos after 16 years. <http://dgit.in/OdyssyPhbs>

# Startup Competitions in India

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here is no right time or formula to get a good idea, especially if that idea has the potential to be the

next big startup of the country, maybe even the world! But there is no denying that even the best ideas sometimes find it hard to find the right traction and support before eventually dying out in today's world. Thankfully, there are quite a few startup competitions that are trying to do their bit in highlighting the best among the best. These competitions are providing startups the necessary platform, along with mentorship, funding and even step-by-step guidance in some cases.

While there are a lot of accelerators out there, catering to various startup verticals and industry areas, what we are looking at today are more competitive events that let startups compete against each other for a winning position. Let's just say that if you have an idea for a startup, applying for a startup competition is one of the best ways you can go to get your idea noticed and even give it an adequate platform to grow to its full potential. But out of all the competitions out there, which ones should you apply for? We've got your back on that one.

## QUALCOMM DESIGN IN INDIA

After a successful first round last year, Qualcomm was back in 2017 with Design in India Challenge II. With an aim to make India an innovation hub,

this competition invites applications from all startups based in India with a minimum of 6 months of operations in hardware design and solutions, mainly in the areas of smart infrastructure, biometric devices, payment terminals, agricultural technology, medical technology and rural IoT. Ideally, your product should be designed using Snapdragon SoCs and/or other Qualcomm products, but there's no



such strict restriction. What is crucial, though, is that your product showcases a relevance to "community and technology" related demand in India.

Why should you apply? First of all, this is one of the few competitions out there that is focussed on actual hardware ideas. There are typically two cycles to this competition, from January to August and from July to December respectively. In each cycle of

Startup competitions are great platforms to showcase startups and get them noticed

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QDIC II, up to 6 shortlisted companies get a cash prize of \$10,000 each to convert their design submissions into workable prototypes using the Qualcomm Innovation Lab. These shortlisted companies also get 6 months of technical support and mentoring in the Qualcomm Innovation Lab at the end of which, they are judged at the grand finale event and up to 2 winning companies stand to win up to \$75,000 each in prize money. In this year's edition, the first cycle was won by Tagbox Solutions Pvt. Ltd and Steradian Semiconductors Pvt. Ltd. While the former has designed an ultra-low power wireless platform, the latter has developed a high resolution 4D radar to enable true all-weather vision for autonomous vehicles and drones. To know more about QDIC, check out <http://dgit.in/qualcommdic>.

## WHARTON INDIA STARTUP CHALLENGE

Want to take part in a competition that led to startups like Ketto, Zostel and BabyChakra? Wharton India Startup Challenge would be the one you're looking for. Currently accepting applications for its fifth edition, the competition from Wharton India Economic Fo-